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Every era has its defining challenge

1 **Scale**
The defining challenge of the twentieth century — **20th century**

2 **Transformation**
The defining challenge of the early twenty-first century — **Early 21st**

3 **Coherence**
The defining challenge of the complexity era — **Now**

As complexity, interdependence and the pace of change continue to increase, many organisational challenges may share a common cause: **a growing gap between complexity and coherence.**

SYMPTOMS THAT MAY SHARE ONE CAUSE

1. Decision bottlenecks
2. Governance congestion
3. Transformation fatigue
4. Fragmented execution

The manuscript argues that the key leadership question is no longer how organisations become more capable, but how they remain coherent as complexity expands.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- ✔ Scale, then transformation, now coherence.
- ✔ Familiar symptoms may share one cause: the complexity–coherence gap.
- ✔ The organisations that thrive preserve coordinated movement while adapting.